

Oct 1, 2026

Sprint Review

Invited Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme Dhairya Shah Samarth Babbar Ajlan Okman
Laura Barcellos Sait Yucekaya

Attachments  Sprint Review

Meeting records  Transcript

Summary

Platform roadmap reviewed and financial portal refined via team alignment

Institutional Intelligence and Metrics Alignment

Platform metrics and intelligence layers were clarified. Leadership established clear design hierarchies and reporting structures.

Financial Portal and UX Refinements

The student financials interface was comprehensively restructured. Specific visual categorization and calculation standards were mandated.

Environment Architecture and Closing Plans

A multi-environment deployment strategy was established. Immediate sprint deliverables and extended standups were finalized.

Decisions

Aligned

- **Feature specification and review workflow process** The team aligned on a formal workflow requiring written feature specifications by Laura, review and approval by Zaibis, and subsequent engineering implementation.
- **Adoption of drawer format for calculation details** The team aligned on using a drawer format for financial and tuition item details to display itemized calculation math.
- **Financial aid color-coding visual standards** The group established visual color-coding standards representing grants in green, accepted loans in purple or blue, and unaccepted aid with striped patterns.
- **Establishment of multi-environment deployment strategy** The team established a multi-environment deployment strategy consisting of Dev for developers, Demo for user testing with demo-specific buttons, Stage for fully approved features, and Prod for the client environment.

Next steps

- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Update User Interface: Remove the top item from the user interface as discussed in the meeting.
- ☐ [The group] Clarify Email Metrics: Aggregate the nine emails into specific categories like pending responses and unread important messages to provide clear metric logic.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos, Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme] Refine Intelligence Insights: Define the ontology and user experience copy for institutional intelligence insights. Create stories and test them to ensure they present data clearly.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos] Improve Email Layout: Adjust the email layout to prevent overlap between UI elements and improve functionality when toggling between email and calendar views.

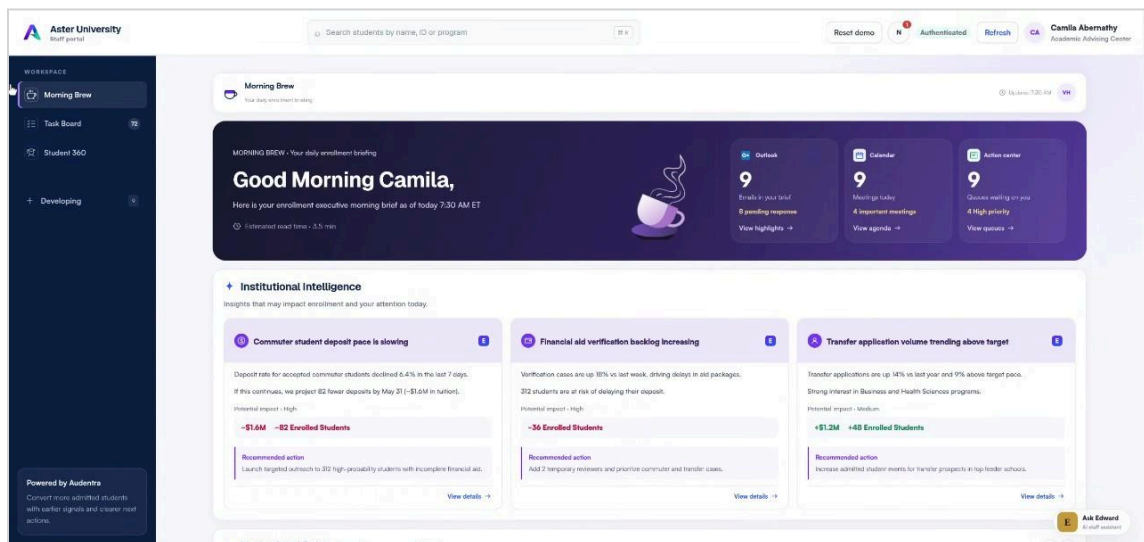
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Create News Pipeline: Build a real-time data pipeline for the news card to display current articles instead of outdated ones.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos, Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme] Define Editorial Logic: Develop the editorial logic and prompting framework for intelligence insights based on the new real-time news feed.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos] Update Financial UI: Replace the artificial intelligence generated headshot with an actual image. Add professional titles and direct contact links for financial aid contacts while removing the assistant button.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Add Feedback Mechanism: Implement a thumbs up or thumbs down feature on prep sheets that triggers a popup with checkbox categories for specific feedback.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos, Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme] Refine financial terminology: Improve clarity of tuition and housing terminology including meal plan options and room specifics. Work with Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme to refine the language.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Fix hover animation: Fix the hover animation on the wheel component to ensure it highlights correct items. Enable the cross-highlighting functionality.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Implement drawer details: Implement a drawer format for displaying detailed breakdown math for tuition and expenses. Ensure the calculation logic is personalized to the student.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos, Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme] Document enrollment deposit: Draft documentation for the proposed enrollment deposit credit and review the proposal with Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Update UI colors: Assign distinct colors to loan categories and implement scattered lines to visually distinguish unaccepted aid.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Prioritize AI insights: Structure AI insights to prioritize the most critical next steps at the top of the view. Maintain a consistent architecture for these insights.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Update financial breakdown: Add a remaining amount field for loans and implement drop-down periods for family allowances. Rename expected campus earnings to federal work study.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Configure housing pop-up: Configure a dynamic pop-up for off-campus housing options. Display monthly rent fields when off-campus housing is selected.

- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Update sunburst chart: Add green visual indicators for underspent status and red indicators for overspent status on the sunburst chart. Ensure both rings align to the same data.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Rephrase simulator: Rephrase the simulator language to focus on planning ahead for the next semester. Ensure the tone is proactive.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos] Optimize enrollment labels: Conduct a User Experience exercise to determine the optimal sizing for enrollment labels. Avoid overly large or crumbled text.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos] Rename contact point: Rename the payment point of contact to student accounts. Remove references to financial aid for payment-related sections.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Add payment actions: Add actionable options for set up a payment plan or direct deposit in the estimated balance section. Implement color-coded balance status.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Consolidate payment views: Merge the payment schedule with the proposed payment schedule. Remove the separate financial calendar view.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Enhance scholarship display: Add boilerplate descriptions and linear progress indicators for all scholarships and grants. Move gray technical text into descriptive blurbs.
- ☐ [Dhairya Shah] Enable offer actions: Enable direct accept and deny functionality for all loans and grants. Include parent plus loans in the loan details.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos] Submit morning brew edits: Deliver the morning brew edits and updates to the team. Ensure all agreed-upon changes are implemented.
- ☐ [Sait Yucekaya] Establish staging: Establish a staging environment that exclusively contains approved features. Ensure functionality matches the production-ready requirements.
- ☐ [Sait Yucekaya] Add Demo Buttons: Create buttons with a dash outline for demonstration purposes. Implement unique styling to distinguish these elements from standard features.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos] Provide Changes: Communicate the specific adjustments required for Morning Brew. Ensure all necessary modifications are shared for implementation.
- ☐ [The group] Update Morning Brew: Complete the required changes by the end of the day. Aim to ship the updates before the week concludes.

- ❑ [The group] Finalize DSM: Resolve outstanding items related to the DSM task. Ensure all remaining details are addressed for completion.

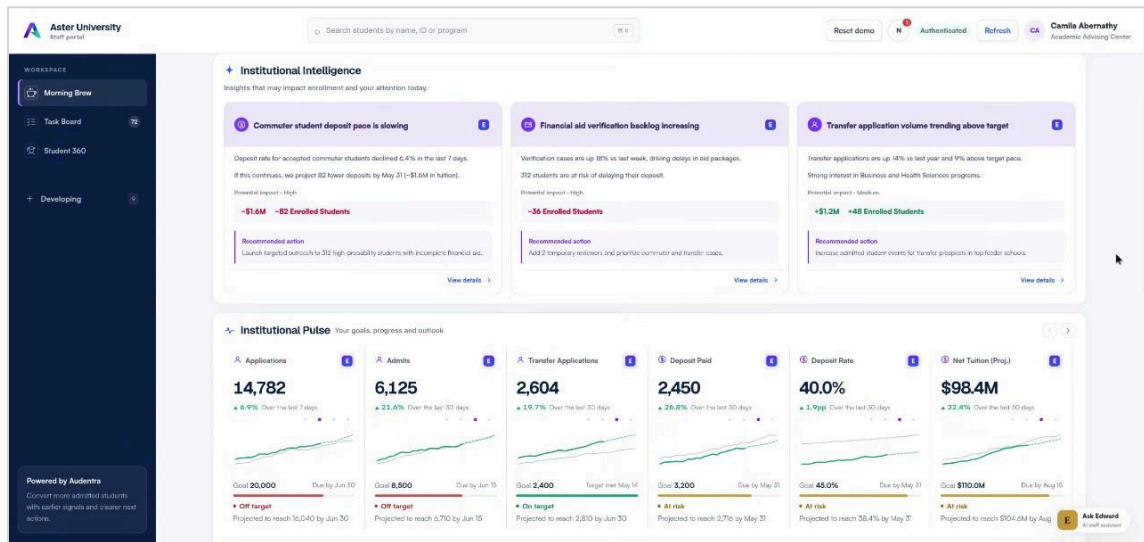
Details

- **Morning Brief Email and Meeting Metrics Alignment:** Ajlan Okman addressed confusing UI copy, specifically instructing the team to remove a misleading top user label and to clarify the "nine emails in your brief" metric. They established that the email count must be an aggregate sum of unread important emails, pending response emails, and sent emails awaiting replies. The team agreed that the breakdown must logically categorize metrics into pending responses, important meetings, high-priority open queues, and tasks to ensure clear user understanding.



- **Institutional Intelligence vs. Institutional Pulse:** Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme, Laura Barcellos, and Ajlan Okman clarified the core architectural distinction between the "Institutional Pulse" and "Institutional Intelligence" layers (00:01:18). Ajlan Okman explained that Institutional Pulse tracks the primary delta against fixed institutional goals (analogous to velocity/distance), whereas Institutional Intelligence analyzes the "delta delta" (acceleration) to evaluate workflow speeds, stage durations, and SLA compliance. Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme noted that senior leaders especially value this intelligence layer, and Ajlan Okman

highlighted that directors should be able to toggle the feature on or off based on team preferences ([00:02:50](#)).



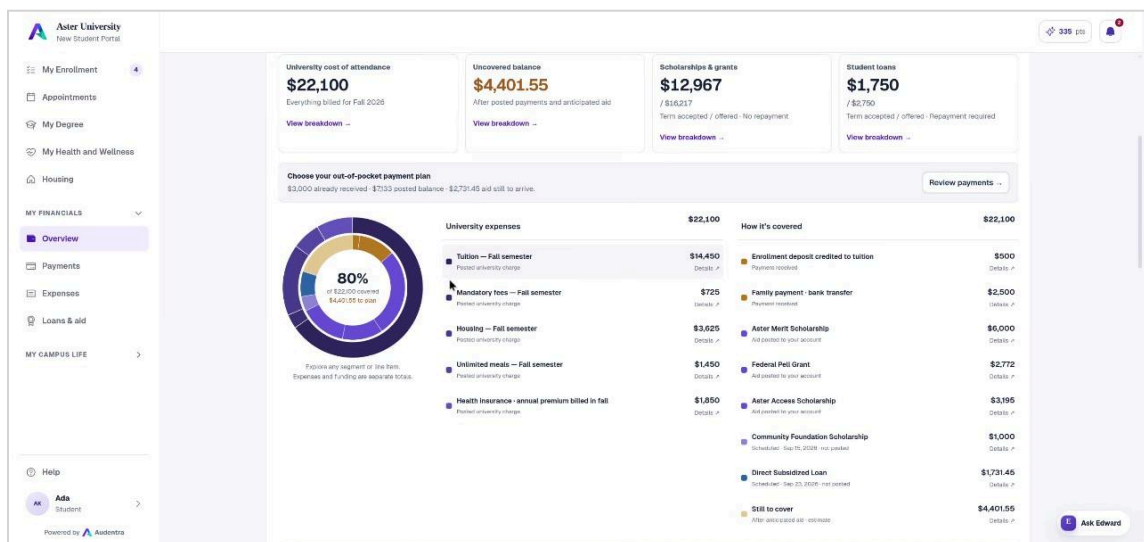
- UX Copywriting and Hierarchy for Institutional Intelligence:** Discussion focused on the draft layout for the Institutional Intelligence card. Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme and Ajlan Okman criticized the current design for lacking a clear visual hierarchy (H1, H2, H3), pointing out that while key numbers like "\$1.6 million negative 82 students" draw immediate attention, the overarching headline (e.g., "Commuter student deposit pace is slowing down") is lost ([00:05:42](#)). Ajlan Okman instructed Laura Barcellos and Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme to collaborate on writing smart, contextual copy and developing an explicit ontology before sending the designs to Dhairya Shah ([00:05:03](#)) ([00:06:38](#)).
- Defining Insight Structures and Agentic Actions:** Ajlan Okman provided a detailed blueprint for how intelligence insights must be structured: a clear comparison headline, comparative historical supporting data in a detailed gray section, a clear statement of potential financial or operational impact, and explicit recommended "agentic" actions ([00:06:38](#)). Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme emphasized that higher education administrators need these direct explanations and numerical breakdowns because they struggle to synthesize complex insights independently, making this AI narrative capability a major selling point ([00:09:15](#)).
- Institutional Pulse Approval and Edward AI Integration:** Laura Barcellos and Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme confirmed that the Institutional Pulse module is refined

and ready for presentation, noting positive client feedback during demos when interacting with the "Edward" AI query feature ([00:09:15](#)). Dhairya Shah confirmed that backend integration connecting all operational data directly to Edward will be completed shortly ([00:10:12](#)).

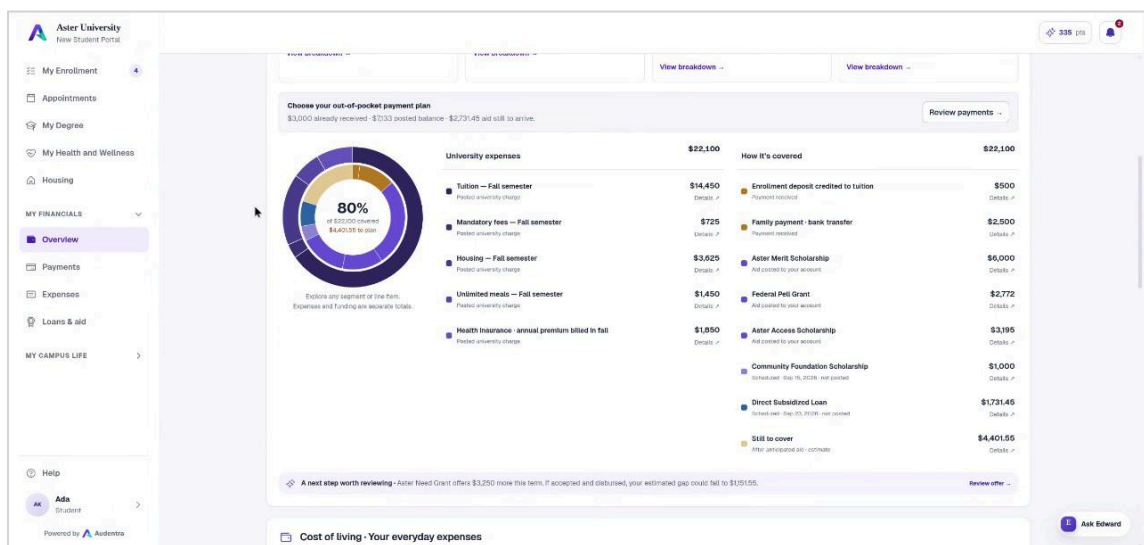
- **Module Prioritization and Feature Roadmap:** The team reviewed the status of secondary features, including the calendar, email safeguard, and action center. Laura Barcellos and Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme agreed that refining these daily productivity tools is a secondary priority compared to delivering a fully realized end-to-end Student Enrollment experience, which offers immediate value for prospective clients like FIU ([00:10:52](#)).
- **Email Interface UX Improvements:** Reviewing the email draft screen, Ajlan Okman shared feedback from a UX designer, requesting that the action arrow near the "send reply" button be repositioned facing upward and styled in a distinct purple shade to avoid accidental sends ([00:12:50](#)).
- **Contextual Calendar Integration in Email View:** Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme raised a core usability issue: users reading emails that request meetings currently cannot view their calendar without closing the modal or leaving the app for Outlook. To prevent context-switching, Ajlan Okman, Laura Barcellos, and Dhairya Shah agreed to display related context—including calendar availability, relevant past emails, and attendee details—directly at the bottom of the email drawer.
- **Intelligence Intent Segmentation and Automated Meeting Scheduling:** Ajlan Okman detailed a new two-part feature requirement for meeting-related emails: detecting scheduling intent, displaying a suggested meeting time based on calendar availability, and allowing the user to either inject the proposed time into the email draft or directly create a calendar invite ([00:19:34](#)). Laura Barcellos committed to documenting this epic and feature workflow ([00:22:47](#)).
- **Product Development Workflow and Process Governance:** Ajlan Okman reiterated the mandatory cross-functional workflow: Laura Barcellos drafts feature stories and passes them to Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme for sign-off; Ajlan Okman tests and approves epics; engineering leads create implementation tasks; and Sait Yucekaya validates technical completion ([00:22:47](#)).
- **Calendar Prep Feedback Mechanism:** To evaluate the accuracy of calendar preparation sheets, Ajlan Okman instructed Dhairya Shah to add a thumbs

up/thumbs down feedback widget (00:23:50). Upon clicking, a quick pop-up will present four predefined check-box categories alongside an optional free-text box to gather structured user sentiment .

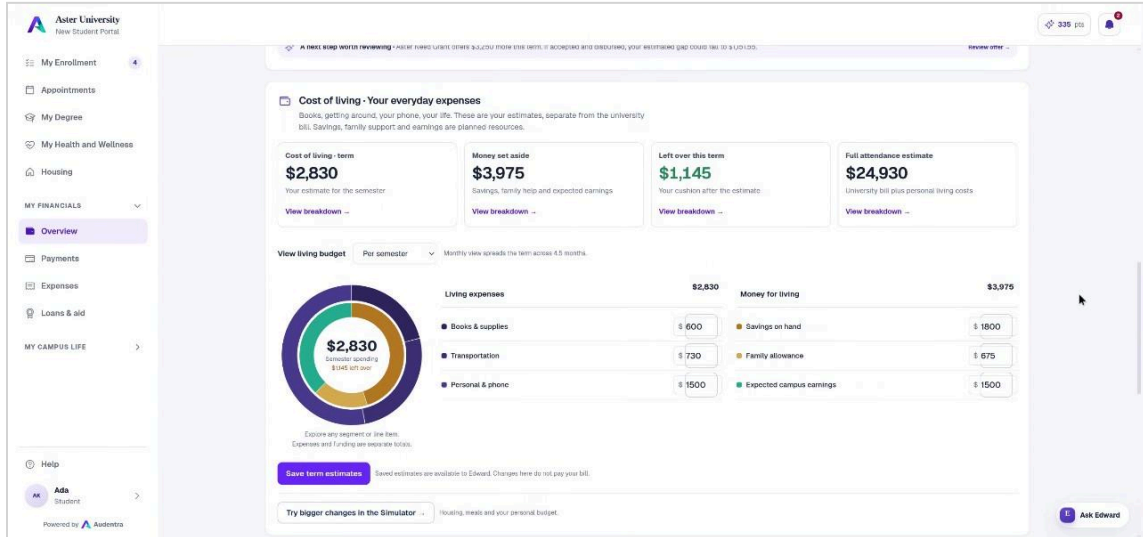
- **Higher Education News Pipeline Architecture:** Reviewing the Higher Ed News section, Ajlan Okman noted that the displayed articles and insights were outdated (00:27:08). Dhairya Shah was tasked with building a real-time data ingestion pipeline first . Once live, Laura Barcellos and Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme will develop prompt guidelines, skill files, and editorial logic across five sample use cases to synthesize live news with institutional performance metrics .
- **Student Portal - My Financials Overview:** The team transitioned to reviewing the Student Portal, prioritizing the "My Financials" view because Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme identified it as the primary selling point for institutional clients (00:26:07) (00:32:28).
- **Financial Aid Contact UX Refinement:** Ajlan Okman criticized the Financial Aid contact component, noting that displaying "Immani Blackwood - Financial Aid Contact" provides redundant information. He instructed the team to update the display to a three-line layout showing the contact's exact title (e.g., Aid Specialist III), clear contact details (phone and email), and a realistic photo instead of an AI-generated headshot (00:34:30). Furthermore, the team decided to remove the standalone Edward icon from this card, replacing it with direct mail-to links and calendar appointment links .



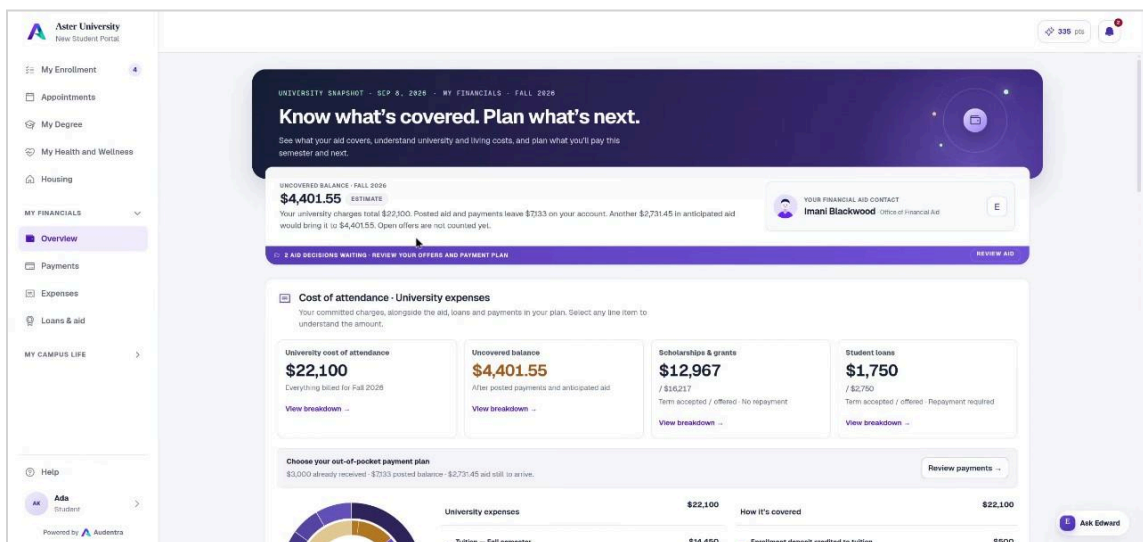
- Cost of Attendance Breakdown & Visual Redundancies:** The team audited the Cost of Attendance list, calling out vague or redundant labels such as "unlimited meals" and repetitive "fall semester" tags. Ajlan Okman and Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme called for specific descriptions (e.g., "10 meal plan per week", "Double room", "Tuition - Full-time") ([00:36:53](#)). Ajlan Okman also noted that interactive hover animations between the line items and the spending wheel were currently broken and must be repaired ([00:39:16](#)).
- Financial Item Details Drawer and Calculation Math:** Addressing feedback from recent client demos, Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme and Ajlan Okman specified that clicking "details" on any financial row must open a drawer showing exact mathematical calculations (e.g., 12 credits at \$220/credit) and institutional policy descriptions ([00:40:17](#)). Ajlan Okman also emphasized condensing vertical whitespace to fix layout misalignment between row titles and amounts ([00:41:10](#)).



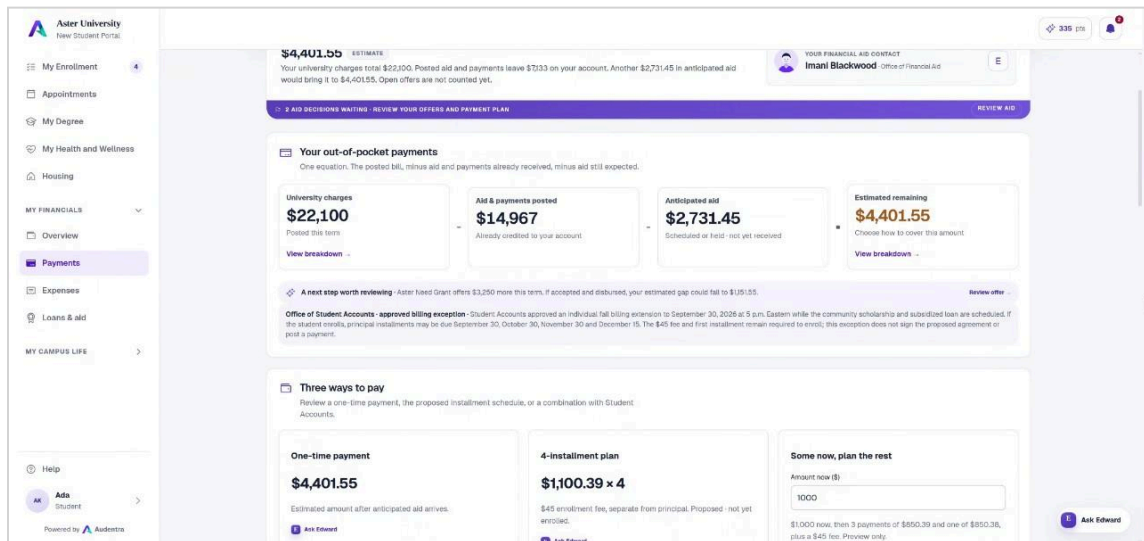
- Visual Categorization and Color Scheme for Aid and Loans:** To clearly differentiate financial categories, the team mandated explicit visual distinctions: grants and non-repayable scholarships should be displayed in green, loans in blue/purple, and self-pay or out-of-pocket costs in orange ([00:44:51](#)). For unaccepted or pending financial aid offers, Ajlan Okman instructed the team to implement a striped pattern (e.g., purple-and-white or blue-and-white) to visually signify unconfirmed funds ([00:45:46](#)).



- AI Insight Hierarchy on Financial Pages:** Ajlan Okman required that critical financial insights—such as pending grant offers requiring student action—must always be positioned at the very top of the page rather than at the bottom, ensuring immediate visual impact .
- Personal Living Expenses and Off-Campus Housing Calculations:** The team restructured the personal expense calculator . Ajlan Okman outlined specific unit requirements for each line item: Federal Work Study (per semester), family allowance (selectable period via drop-down), personal/utilities (per month), and transportation (selectable per month or per semester) (00:52:42). He added that for students living off-campus, a dynamic "monthly rent" row must automatically appear (00:54:08).

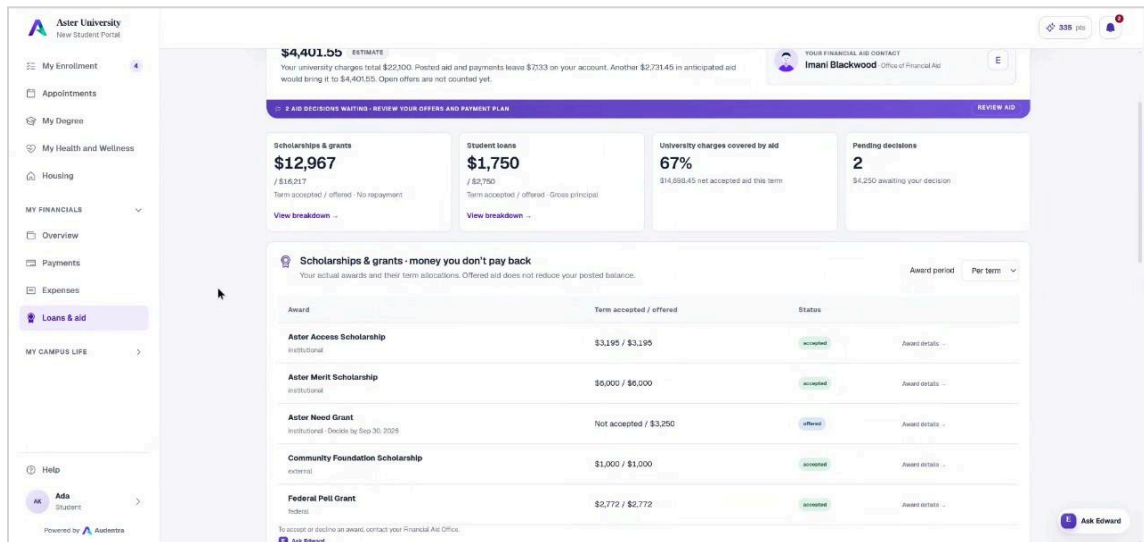


- Sunburst Spending Wheel Adjustments:** Examining the living expense sunburst chart, Ajlan Okman noted that the inner ring represents living funds while the outer ring represents expenses. He instructed the team to add a distinct green slice on the outer ring when a student is under budget to reflect net remaining monthly cash (e.g., \$254/month), or a red slice on the inner ring when over budget ([00:55:37](#)).

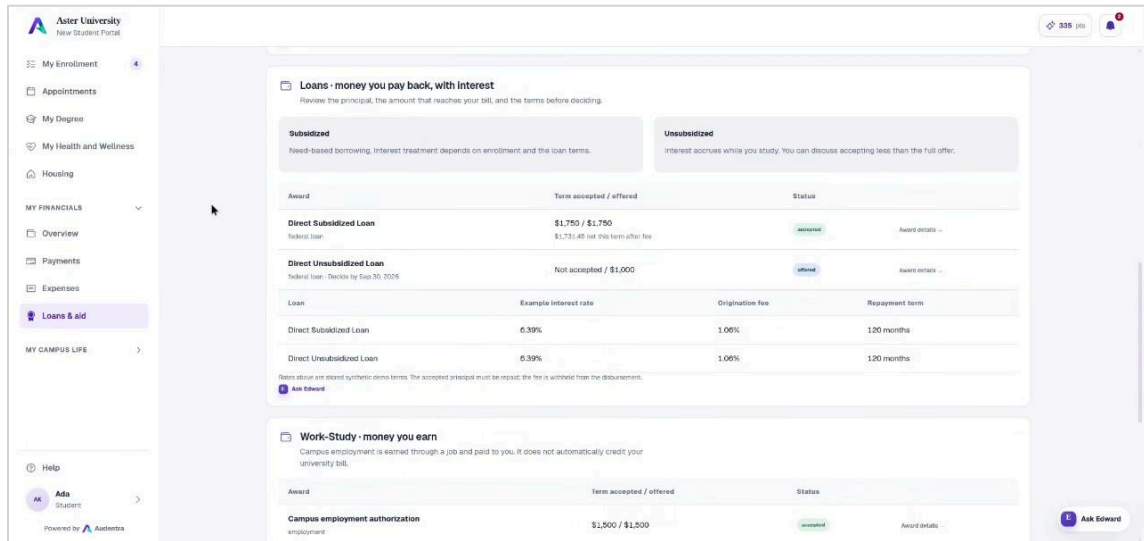


- Simulator Terminology and UI Sizing:** Ajlan Okman noted that tracking variances (such as "missing 254") ensures budget numbers align whether over or under budget. Ajlan Okman suggested rephrasing the simulator's purpose to planning ahead for the upcoming semester rather than focusing on "bigger changes," noting that students for the current semester are already committed, placed in housing, and have had their financial aid cut. Additionally, Ajlan Okman stated that "off" is the wrong language and "enrolled" is too small, suggesting "enrolled / not enrolled" instead. Ajlan Okman instructed Laura Barcellos to conduct a UX research exercise to determine the optimal minimum UI text size, expressing a preference for smaller, elegant text over oversized elements, while Dhairya Shah agreed to the overall direction ([00:58:58](#)).
- Payment Point of Contact and Financial Categorization:** Ajlan Okman instructed Laura Barcellos to change the point of contact for payments from financial aid to student accounts or BSAR (Bursar) ([01:00:26](#)). Ajlan Okman outlined a revised bucket structure for financial reporting: University Charges, Financial Aids Accepted and Posted, Loans Accepted and Posted, and a separate bucket for Payments and Credits Posted (including enrollment

deposits). For the estimated remaining balance, Ajlan Okman specified that positive balances should be displayed in red with actionable prompts like "set up a payment plan" or "make a payment," while negative balances should be displayed in green with options to schedule a direct deposit ([01:01:36](#)).



- Payment Options, UI Consistency, and Schedule Redesign:** Ajlan Okman clarified that only two ways to pay exist—a one-time payment or an installment plan—and instructed the team to remove the "three ways to pay" structure. Ajlan Okman noted that the "Ask Edward" feature was inconsistent and required placing the Edward logo ("E") systematically on the right side ([01:03:25](#)). Ajlan Okman asked for inclusive language covering all student stages, including payout methods (direct deposit, check, ACH) for over-covered balances, confirmation statuses, and upcoming payment amounts and dates ([01:05:11](#)). Additionally, Ajlan Okman and Laura Barcellos agreed to remove the financial calendar display, as it was overly confusing and repeated information already present in the payment schedule and plan. Ajlan Okman noted that aid disbursement dates should instead be integrated directly into the accept/deny flows on the loans and aid page ([01:06:26](#)).



- Navigation Hierarchy and Financial Page Content:** Ajlan Okman recommended reordering the main financial navigation to: Financial Overview, Aid and Loans (showing aid before loans), Payments, and lastly Expenses, as expenses will be the least frequently viewed. For the scholarships and grants section, Ajlan Okman requested improved UX writing, making sure the Edward AI assistant is present so users can view breakdowns or ask questions ([01:07:36](#)). Ajlan Okman suggested replacing technical descriptions with human-friendly boilerplate text (e.g., explaining that scholarships and grants do not require repayment) and using visual progress bars or linear graphs—similar to Morning Brew's layout—to represent pending, accepted (in green), and declined (in red) funds ([01:09:05](#)).
- Scholarships, Grants, and Loan Acceptance UX:** Ajlan Okman stated that users should be able to accept or deny scholarships and grants directly on the page using a binary (yes/no) selection. For loans, Ajlan Okman required a rich text input field allowing students to accept partial loan amounts (e.g., accepting \$500 out of an offered \$1,000) ([01:12:12](#)). Ajlan Okman instructed the team to eliminate duplicate tables by merging loan details with award details, renaming "award details" to "loan details," displaying exact interest rates (e.g., Direct Subsidized Loan at 6.39%) next to each loan, and clearly explaining subsidized versus unsubsidized terms ([01:13:27](#)). Ajlan Okman also asked the team to research adding Parent PLUS loans to cover all four federal loan types. Furthermore, Ajlan Okman noted that work-study terms and disbursement

schedules should be consolidated into the main loan table, displaying scheduled posting dates immediately after acceptance ([01:14:56](#)).

- **Expense Review Wrap-Up and AI Feature Feedback:** Laura Barcellos requested wrapping up the session as attention was fading, noting they could cover expenses later. Ajlan Okman expressed pride in the team's progress on financial literacy features and commended Dhairya Shah for building them quickly before demonstrating to Rosemary ([01:16:14](#)). Laura Barcellos, Dhairya Shah, and Ajlan Okman praised the intelligence of the Edward AI tool, with Laura Barcellos emphasizing the need to focus on delivering immediate sprint priorities before holding dedicated functional sessions on Edward's user experience ([01:17:20](#)).
- **Daily Standup (DSM) Planning and Immediate Deliverables:** Laura Barcellos planned to create a spreadsheet documenting feedback for the team and scheduled extended daily standup meetings (DSM) to complete reviews of the financial, enrollment, and appointment features. Ajlan Okman requested incremental progress rather than waiting for the next day's standup, asking Laura Barcellos to deliver edits for the Morning Brew feature within the next hour so Dhairya Shah could begin work on it immediately ([01:18:28](#)).
- : * **Dev / Test:** Used by developers and Laura Barcellos for active building\~=CITATION:71=\~.
 - * **Demo:** A stabilized environment for Zy, containing working or mocked UI components and demo-specific features (e.g., a dashed-outline button to instantly upload test transcripts) to ensure presentations run smoothly without backend interruptions\~=CITATION:71=\~\~=CITATION:73=\~.
 - * **Stage:** Managed by Ajlan Okman, containing fully completed, end-to-end approved frontend and backend features\~=CITATION:72=\~.
 - * **Prod:** The client-facing production environment\~=CITATION:72=\~.
- **Meeting Closing and Action Items:** Laura Barcellos agreed to summarize all meeting feedback, provide Morning Brew update requirements by the end of the day, and expand the following day's DSM meeting to complete the remaining product reviews ([01:25:17](#)). The meeting concluded with informal team banter regarding multilingual exchanges before wrapping up ([01:24:09](#)).

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